

0.0.1 The Brahma Tissa

tissabrahma suttaṃ

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Rajagaha on the Gijjhakuta mountain. Then the night having advanced, two devas of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the whole Gijjhakuta, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, they stood to one side. Standing to one side, one deva said this to the Auspicious One. “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are liberated.” Another deva said this to the Auspicious One: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are well-liberated without residue remaining.” This is what those devas said. The Teacher approved. Those devas [knowing], The Teacher has approved, having bowed down, having circumambulated the Auspicious One, they disappeared right there.

evaṃ me suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā rājagahe viharati gijjhakūṭe pabbate. atha kho dve devatā abhikkantāya rattiyaṃ abhikkantavaṇṇā kevalakappaṃ gijjhakūṭaṃ obhāsetvā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamimṃsu. upasaṅkamtvaṃ bhagavantaṃ abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhaṃsu. ekamantaṃ ṭhitā kho ekā devatā bhagavantaṃ etadavoca: etā bhante bhikkhuniyo vimuttāti. aparā devatā bhagavantaṃ etadavoca etā bhante bhikkhuniyo anupādisesā suvimuttāti. idamavocaṃ tā devatā. sa-

manuñño satthā ahosi. atha kho tā devatā samanūñño satthāti bhagavantam abhivādetvā padakkhiṇam katvā tatthevantaradhāyimsu.

2. Then when the night had passed, the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus. “This night, O bhikkhus, two devas of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the whole Gijjhakuta, visited me. Upon arrival, having bowed down to me, they stood to one side. Having stood to one side, one deva said this to me: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are liberated.” Another deva said this to me: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are well-liberated without residue remaining.” This, O bhikkhus, is what those devas said. Having said this, having bowed down, having circumambulated me, they disappeared right there.”

atha kho bhagavā tassā rattiyā accayena bhikkhū āmantesi: imaṃ bhikkhave, rattiṃ dve devatā abhikkantāya rattiyā abhikkantavaṇṇā kevalakappam gijjhakūṭam obhāsetvā yenāhaṃ tenupasaṅkamimsu. upasaṅkamitvā maṃ abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhaṃsu. ekamantaṃ t̥hitā kho bhikkhave ekā devatā maṃ etadavoca: etā bhante, bhikkhuniyo vimuttāti. aparā devatā maṃ etadavoca: etā bhante, bhikkhuniyo anupādisesā suvimuttāti. idamavocaṃ bhikkhave, tā devatā. idaṃ vatvā maṃ abhivādetvā padakkhiṇam katvā tatthevantaradhāyimsu’ti.

3. At that time, the venerable Mahamoggallana was seated not far from the Auspicious One. Then for the venerable Mahamoggallana, this occurred: “For which devas is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

tena kho pana samayena āyasmā mahāmoggallāno bhagavato avidūre nisinno hoti. atha kho āyasmato mahā moggallānassa etadahosi: kamesānaṃ kho devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti savupādisese vā savupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

4. Now at that time a bhikkhu named Tissa had recently passed away and arisen in a certain brahma world. There too they knew him thus: “The brahma Tissa, of great power, of great majesty.”

tena kho pana samayena tisso nāma bhikkhu adhunā kālakato aññataraṃ brahmalokaṃ upapanno hoti. tatrapī naṃ evaṃ jānanti: “tisso brahmā mahidhiko mahānubhāvo”ti.

5. So then, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so the venerable Mahamoggallana disappeared from the Gijjhakuta mountain and appeared in the brahma world. The brahma Tissa saw the venerable Mahamoggallana

approaching from afar. Having seen, he said this to the venerable Mahamoggallana:

atha kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno seyyathāpi nāma
balavā puriso sammiñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya
pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ sampiñjeyya, evamevaṃ gij-
jhakūṭe pabbate antarahito tasmaṃ brahmaloke
pāturahosi. addasā kho tisso brahmā āyasman-
taṃ mahāmoggallānaṃ dūratova āgacchantaṃ di-
svāna āyasmantaṃ mahāmoggallānaṃ etadavoca:

6. Come dear sir Moggallana, welcome dear sir Mog-
gallana. It has been long, dear sir Moggallana, since
this arrangement was made, specifically for your com-
ing here. Have a seat dear sir Moggallana. This seat
is ready. The venerable Mahamoggallana sat down on
the prepared seat. The brahma Tissa, having bowed
down to the venerable Mahamoggallana, also sat down
to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable
Mahamoggallana said this to the brahma Tissa:

ehi kho mārisa moggallāna, svāgataṃ mārisa mog-
gallāna, cirassaṃ kho mārisa moggallāna, imaṃ
pariyāyamakāsi yadidaṃ idhāgamanāya. nisīda
mārisa moggallāna, idamāsanam paññattanti. ni-
sīdi kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno paññatte āsane.
tissopi kho brahmā āyasmantaṃ mahāmoggallā-
naṃ abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ
nisinnaṃ kho tissaṃ brahmānaṃ āyasmā mahā

moggallāno etadavoca:

7. “For which devas is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

katamesānaṃ kho tissa, devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti?

8. “For the devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

brahmakāyikānaṃ kho mārīsa moggallāna, devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hotī: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

9. “Is there knowledge, O Tissa, for all the devas of the brahma group, thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

sabbesaṃyeva nu kho¹ tissa, brahmakāyikānaṃ devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

10. Not for all the devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?” Those devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, who are contented with the brahma life span, contented with the brahma beauty, with the brahma happiness, with the brahma fame, with the brahma rulership, those who do not know of a higher escape than that, as it has come to be, for them there is no knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein.” But those devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, who are not contented with the brahma life span, not contented with the brahma beauty, with the brahma happiness, with the brahma fame, with the brahma rulership, those who know of a higher escape than that, as it has come to be, for them there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

na kho mārīsa moggallāna, sabbesaṃ brahmakāyikānaṃ devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti. ye kho te mārīsa moggallāna, brahmakāyikā devā brahmena āyunaṃ santuṭṭhā, brahmena vaṇṇena brahmena sukkena brahmena yasena brahmena ādhipateyyena santuṭṭhā, tassa ca uttarim² nisaraṇaṃ yathābhūtaṃ nappajānantī, tesāṃ na evaṃ

ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti. ye ca kho te mārisa moggallāna, brahmacārikā devā brahmena āyuna asantutthā, brahmena vaṇṇena brahmena sukhena brahmena yasena brahmena ādhipateyyena asantutthā, tassa ca uttarim² nissaraṇaṃ yathābhūtaṃ pajānanti, tesam evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

11. Here dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is both ends liberated. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is both ends liberated. For as long as his body remains, for that long devas and humans will see him. With the breakup of the body, after death, devas and humans will not see him.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha mārisa moggallāna bhikkhu ubhatobhāgavimutto hoti tamenam devā¹ evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā ubhatobhāgavimutto, yāvassa kāyo tthassati tāva naṃ dakkhanti devamanussā, kāyassa bhedaṃ na naṃ dakkhanti devamanussāti evampi kho mārisa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

12. Still here dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is wisdom liberated. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is wisdom liberated. For as long as his body remains, for that long devas and humans will see him. With the breakup of the body, after death, devas and humans will not see him.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna, bhikkhu paññāvimutto hoti tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā paññāvimutto, yāvassa kāyo ṭhassati tāva naṃ dakkhanti devamanussā, kāyassa bheda, na naṃ dakkhanti devamanussāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesaṃ devānaṃ nāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

13. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a body witness. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a body witness. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having re-

alized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu kāyasakkhī hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā kāyasakkhi, appeva nāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyayamāno, yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti. saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

14. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is one attained to view. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is attained to view. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this

very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu diṭṭhappatto¹ hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayam kho āyasmā diṭṭhappatto¹ appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyāmāno, yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesaṃ devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

15. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is liberated by faith. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is liberated by faith. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas

there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu saddhāvimutto hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā saddhāvimutto appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalayānamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyāmāno, yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariya-pariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānam evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

16. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a Dhamma follower. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a Dhamma follower. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,”

when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu dhammānusārī hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā dhammānusārī appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalayānamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannānayaṃ māno, yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariya-pariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

17. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a faith follower. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a faith follower. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual

remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu saddhānūsārī hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā saddhānūsārī appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannānāyāmāno, yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

18. Then the venerable Mahamoggallana having delighted in, having rejoiced in the brahma Tissa’s words, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so the venerable Mahamoggallana disappeared from the brahma world and appeared in the Gijjhakuta mountain.

atha kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno tissassa brahmuno bhāsitaṃ abhinanditvā anumoditvā seyyāthāpi nāma balavā puriso sammiñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya, pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ sammiñjeyya, evameva brahmaloke antarahito gijjhakūṭe pātura-hosi.

19. Then the venerable Mahamoggallana visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Mahamoggallana informed the Auspicious One the full extent of his friendly conversation with the brahma Tissa.

atha kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno yāvatako ahosi tis-sena brahmunā saddhiṃ kathāsallāpo taṃ sabbaṃ bhagavato ārocesi.

20. “But for you Moggallana, did not the brahma Tissa explain to you about the seventh individual, the one who dwells in the signless?”

nahi pana te moggallāna tisso brahmā sattamaṃ animittavihāriṃ puggalaṃ desesīti.

21. “This is the appropriate time, O Auspicious One, this is the appropriate time, O Well-farer, the Auspicious One should teach about the seventh individual, the one who dwells in the signless? Having heard from the Auspicious One, the bhikkhus will bear it in mind.”

etassa bhagavā kālo, etassa sugata kālo, yaṃ bhagavā sattamaṃ animittavihāriṃ puggalaṃ deseyya,

bhagavato sutvā bhikkhū dhāressantīti.

22. “Well then, Moggallana, listen and do mind it well. I will speak.”

tena hi moggallāna suṇāhi, sādhukaṃ manasikarohi, bhāsisāmīti.

23. “Yes, Bhante,” the venerable Mahamoggallana replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

evambhanteti kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno bhagavato paccassosi. bhagavā etadavoca:

24. Here, O Moggallana, by non-attention to all signs, a bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the signless samadhi state of mind. By that the devas understand thus: “By non-attention to all signs, this venerable one enters upon and dwells in the signless samadhi state of mind. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too, O Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual

remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

idha moggallāna, bhikkhu sabbanimittānaṃ amanasikārā animittaṃ cetosamādhim upasampajja viharati. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayam kho āyasmā sabbanimittānaṃ amanasikārā animittaṃ cetosamādhim upasampajja viharati. appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyayamāno yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evaṃ kho moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ ñānaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

